

Long Pepper (पिप्पली/Pippali)

Piper Longum

Class: Magnoliopsida

Family: Piperaceae

Genus: Piper

Leaf characteristics



Length	5 - 9 cm
Width	3 - 5 cm
Shape	Cordate

Key identification: elongated, conical shape and clustered, small fruits that resemble tiny berries merging into a single rod-like structure

Uses: spices, cough, cold, diabetes, bacterial infections, weight loss

Best climate: hot, humid climate and elevation 100 to 1000 MSL, partial shade 20-25 % intensity

Native to: Indo-Malaya region, found growing wild in the tropical rainforests of India.

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Indian Ginseng (अश्वगंधा/Ashwagandha)

Withania Somnifera

Class: Angiospermae

Family: Solanaceae

Genus: Withania

Leaf characteristics



Length	10 - 12 cm
Width	2.5 - 7.5 cm
Shape	Oval

Key identification: Short and plump with velvet leaves. It has bell flowers that contain orange berries, similar looking to tomatoes

Uses: Ayurvedic and Unani preparations, insomnia, weakness, ulcers and painful swellings

Best climate: Sub-marginal waste lands and low fertility areas

Native to: Drier parts in subtropical regions and upper Gangetic Plains

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Sugandha Kokila (सुगंधा/Sugandha)

Cinnamomum glaucescens

Class: Magnoliids

Family: Lauraceae

Genus: Cinnamomum

Leaf characteristics



Length	5 - 18 cm
Width	2 - 10 cm
Shape	Elliptical

Key identification: glossy, dark green leaves, brown-haired inflorescences, and fruits with aromatic seeds

Uses: Perfumery, dyspepsia, flatulence, diarrhoea, nausea and vomiting

Best Climate: tropical and subtropical montane rainforests

Native to: Bhutan, India, and Nepal

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Malabar nut (वासा/Vasa)

Justicia adhatoda

Class: Asterids

Family: Acanthaceae

Genus: Justicia

Leaf characteristics



Length	10 - 15 cm
Width	4 - 6 cm
Shape	Lance

Key identification: Tea-like odour, bitter taste

Uses: coughs, colds, bronchitis, asthma, tuberculosis, dysentery, diarrhea

Best climate: sub-humid to moderately humid, subtropical and tropical climates

Native to: Afghanistan, and the Indian subcontinent

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Fig (अंजीर/Anjeer)

Ficus Carcia

Class: Rosales

Family: Moraceae

Genus: Ficus

Leaf characteristics



Length	12 - 25 cm
Width	10 - 18 cm
Shape	3 to 5 deep lobes, broad

Key identification: large, lobed leaves, typically with 3-5 lobes, and their pear-shaped fruits, which start green and turn dark purple or brown when ripe

Uses: diabetes, high cholesterol, eczema, psoriasis, and vitiligo

Best climate: warm, subtropical climates with dry summers and wet winters

Native to: Mediterranean region and parts of western and southern Asia

[\[1\]](#) [\[2\]](#) [\[3\]](#) [\[4\]](#)

Heart-leaved moonseed (गिलोय/Giloy)

Tinospora cordifolia

Class: Eudicots

Family: Menispermaceae

Genus: Tinospora

Leaf characteristics



Length	10 - 12 cm
Width	8 - 15 cm
Shape	Heart

Key identification: heart-shaped leaves, long aerial roots, and reddish-orange fruits, the plant's flowers are small and greenish-yellow.

Uses: diabetes, high cholesterol, allergic rhinitis (hay fever), upset stomach, gout, lymphoma

Best climate: subtropical and tropical climates, it prefers a warm, moist environment, with well-drained soil rich in organic matter

Native to: the Indian subcontinent and South Asia

[\[1\]](#) [\[2\]](#) [\[3\]](#) [\[4\]](#)

